Xinde "James" Ji

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Current Position

Assistant Professor, 2026-
Department of Food, Agricultural and Resource Economics, University of Guelph

Previous Academic Positions

Assistant Professor, 2022-2025
Food and Resource Economics Department, University of Florida

Lecturer, 2021-2022
Department of Economics, Brandeis University

Florence Levy Kay Fellow in Environmental Economics, 2019-2021
Department of Economics and the Environmental Studies Program, Brandeis University

Postdoctoral Research Associate, 2018-2019
Department of Forest Resources and Environmental Conservation, Virginia Tech

Education

Ph.D. Virginia Tech, 2014-2018.

M.S. State University of New York - College of Environmental Science and Forestry, 2011-2013.

B.S. Fudan University, 2007-2011.

Research Interests

Environmental and Natural Resource Economics; Climate Change; Economic Development

Publications

Dai, S., **X.J. Ji**, and K. Huang, 2026. Mitigating the Heat: The Role of AI Technology in Shielding Corporate Environmental Performance from Extreme Temperatures—Difference-in-Differences Evidence from Chinese Listed Firms. *Business Strategy and the Environment.* Forthcoming.

Guimbeau, A., **X.J. Ji**, and N. Menon, 2026. Climate shocks, attitudes towards intimate partner violence, and the protective role of climate-resilience projects. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization 249: 107713.*

X.J. Ji, Q. Li, S.J. Lee, M. Luke, and F. Mavrothalassitis, 2026. Cleaner bills, cleaner air: The environmental co-benefits of stringent renewable portfolio standards policy design. *Energy Economics 157: 109242.*

Dai, S., and **X.J. Ji**, 2026. Unintended Carbon Cost of Automation Technology in Transforming Economies: The Role of Capital Dependence and Structure Change. *Ecological Economics 244: 108951.*

Dai, S., **X.J. Ji**, and H. Yu, 2026. Technology import and biased technological progress in transforming economies: evidence from China. *Review of Development Economics 30(2): 1194-1214.*

Guimbeau, A., **X.J. Ji**, Z. Long, and N. Menon, 2024. Ocean salinity, early-life health, and adaptation. *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management 125: 102954.*

Browne, O. and **X.J. Ji**, 2023. The Economic Value of Clarifying Property Rights: Evidence from Water in Idaho's Snake River Basin. *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management 119: 102799.*

Yao, Z., W. Zhang, **X. Ji**, and W. Weng, 2023. Short-Term Exposure to Air Pollution and Cognitive Performance: New Evidence from China's College English Test. *Environmental and Resource Economics 85(1): 211-237.*

Guimbeau, A., **X.J. Ji**, N. Menon, and Y. Rodgers, 2023. Mining and women's agency: Evidence on acceptance of domestic violence and shared decision-making in India. *World Development 162: 106135.*

Cobourn, K. M., **X. Ji**, S. Mooney and N. F. Crescenti, 2022. The effect of prior appropriation water rights on land-allocation decisions in irrigated agriculture. *American Journal of Agricultural Economics 104(3): 947-975.*

He, Q. and **X. Ji**, 2021. The Labor Productivity Consequences of Exposure to Particulate Matters: Evidence from a Chinese National Panel Survey. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health 18(23): 12859.*

Ji, X. and K. M. Cobourn, 2021. Weather Fluctuations, Expectation Formation, and Short-run Behavioral Responses to Climate Change. *Environmental and Resource Economics 78(1): 77-119.*

Maneta, M. P., K. Cobourn, J. S. Kimball, M. He, N. L. Silverman, B. C. Chaffin, S. Ewing, **X. Ji**, and B. Maxwell, 2020. A satellite-driven hydro-economic model to support agricultural water resources management. *Environmental Modelling & Software 134: 104836.*

Wurster, P., M. Maneta, S. Beguería, K. Cobourn, B. Maxwell, N. Silverman, S. Ewing, K. Jencso, P. Gardner, J. Kimball, Z. Holden, **X. Ji**, and S. M. Vicente-Serrano, 2020. Characterizing the impact of climatic and price anomalies on agrosystems in the northwest United States. *Agricultural and Forest Meteorology 280: 107778.*

Ji, X. and K. M. Cobourn, 2018. The Economic Benefits of Irrigation Districts under Prior Appropriation Doctrine: An Econometric Analysis of Agricultural Land-allocation Decisions. *Canadian Journal of Agricultural Economics 66(3): 441-467.*

Working Papers

Partisan Sorting into Natural-Hazard Risk: Evidence from Florida Voters (with Haoluan Wang, Phillip Khaskin, Weizhe Weng, and Leanna Navo)

Mangroves, Mental Health, and Cognitive Functions (with Amanda Guimbeau, Nidhiya Menon, and Firman Witoelar)

A tale of fish and water: Housing market capitalization of freshwater fishery species (with Weizhe Weng, Kevin Boyle, and Lars Rudstam)

The effect of climate change on irrigated agriculture: Water-temperature interaction and adaptation in the Western U.S. (with Weizhe Weng and Kelly Cobourn)

The legacy of HOLC maps: A nationwide study on lead concentration in drinking water (with Haoluan Wang, Weizhe Weng, Yetian Cai, and Gavin Sidhu)

Bridging the Digital Divide: How 3G Internet Coverage Transforms Fertility Decisions in Nigeria (with Yujuan Gao, Conner Mullally, and Jared Gars)

Policy and Outreach Writings

Useche, P., **X.J. Ji**, S. Dai, and G. Onel, 2026. Diverging Paths: How Latin America Is Reorienting Exports amid Geopolitical Tensions. *Choices 41(2): 1-11.*

Snyder, S. L., **X.J. Ji**, W. Weng, D. Fang, S. Thornsbury, M. T. Olexa, and S. Olivnik, 2024. Forever Chemicals and Challenges to Drinking Water Systems. *Choices 39(3): 1-6.*

Academic Presentations

2026: UCL Global Health Workshop; Canadian Health Economists' Study Group (CHESG) Conference; CEA Annual Meeting; Toronto Meeting on the Economics of Climate Change (TMEC); WCERE; BIOECON@Cambridge; CREEA Annual Conference

2025: AERE@ASSA; SEEDS@Georgia Tech; University of Guelph; OSWEET@AERE (virtual); Heartland Env & Res Econ Workshop

2024: Arizona State University; University of Florida Water Symposium; University of Georgia; SEEDS@Georgia Tech; AERE Summer Meeting; Econometric Society North America Summer Meeting; AAEA Annual Meeting; CU Environmental & Res Econ Workshop; SWEEEP@Georgia Tech

2023: AERE@ASSA; ASHEcon; Social Cost of Water Pollution Workshop

2022: University of Florida; AERE Summer Meeting; AAEA Annual Meeting; 100 Years of Development Workshop at Cornell University; SEA Annual Meeting; NBER Development Economics Fall Program Meeting

2021: OSWEET@AERE (virtual); NAREA Annual Meeting (virtual); Harvey Mudd College

2020: EAERE Annual Meeting (virtual)

2019: University of Nebraska–Lincoln; Joint Global Change Research Institute

2018: AGU Fall Meeting; Heartland Env & Res Econ Workshop; CU Environmental & Res Econ Workshop; AAEA Annual Meeting; World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists

2017: AAEA Annual Meeting; SAEA Annual Meeting

Teaching Experience

Instructor

Topics in Environmental Economics (AEB 7483, PhD field course)	*University of Florida*
Principles of Food and Resource Econ (AEB 3103, Undergraduate)	*University of Florida*
Introduction to Nat Res and Env Econ (AEB 3450, Undergraduate)	*University of Florida*
Econometrics (ECON 184b, Undergraduate/Master's)	*Brandeis University*
Climate Change Economics and Policy (ENVS 36b, Undergraduate)	*Brandeis University*
GIS Methods and Skills (ENVS 100b, Undergraduate)	*Brandeis University*
Environmental Economics (ECON 57a, Undergraduate)	*Brandeis University*

Guest Lectures

Institute for Learning in Retirement	*Summer 2023 and 2024, Oak Hammock, Gainesville, FL*
Applied Geographic Information Systems (HS 269b)	*Spring 2020, Brandeis University*
Climate Change: Causes, Impacts, Responses & Solutions (ENVS 39b)	*Fall 2019-2021, Brandeis University*

Environmental Economics (ECON 340)	*Fall 2019, Fall 2020, SUNY-Geneseo*
Natural Resource Policy (FOR 4434)	*Fall 2015, Virginia Tech*
Field Study (FOR 3964)	*Fall 2015, Virginia Tech*

Additional Pedagogical Training and Experience

IFAS Distance Learning Mini-Grant, 2023, University of Florida

IFAS Teacher's College, Fall 2022, University of Florida

Faculty Host, Graduate Student Guest Session on Racial Justice, Fall 2021, Brandeis University

Online Teaching Workshop, Summer 2020, Brandeis University

Center for Teaching and Learning Teaching Fellows, Fall 2019, Brandeis University

Honors and Awards

University of Florida Global Fellow, *2024-2025*

Runner-up, APEC Healthy Women Healthy Economy (HWHE) Research Prize, *2024*

Burruss Fellowship, Virginia Tech, *2017*

Temasek Foundation LEaRN Scholarship, National University of Singapore, *2010*

Grant Fundings

"Where Does the Land Go, and Why? Rapid Farmland Loss and the Push and Pull Factors".
Funding Agency: USDA NIFA-AFRI. Amount requested: $649,579 (USD); awarded: $591,242 (USD).
Awarded February 2026.
Project Role: Principal Investigator.[1]

Professional Activities

Journal Editor: PLOS One (2024-)

Journal Referee: American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; American Journal of Agricultural Economics; Canadian Journal of Agricultural Economics; Climatic Change; Contemporary Economic Policy; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization; Journal of Environmental Economics and Management; Journal of Population Economics; Land Economics; Regional Environmental Change; Spatial Economic Analysis; Water Resource and Economics

Ad hoc reviewer: AAEA Annual Meetings; AERE Annual Meetings; ASHEcon Annual Meetings; French National Research Agency; U.S. National Science Foundation; WCERE

Session Organizer: AERE@ASSA Annual Meetings; AAEA Annual Meetings; EEA Annual Meetings

Topic Leader: AAEA, 2022-2024. Topic: Environmental Economics and Policy

Membership: American Economic Association, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association, Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Canadian Economic Association

Media Coverage and Outreach

"Dr. James Ji Named 2025 UFIC Global Fellow Plans to Explore Health and Social impacts of mangrove ecosystems on coastal communities." *UF/IFAS Blogs*, Dec 2024

[1] Awarded while at the University of Florida; relinquished upon relocation to the University of Guelph.

"Ocean Salinity", *Nature Climate Change*, Apr 2024

Panelist, China Town Hall 2021 - Brandeis University, Sep 2021

Co-Organizer, State Lead for the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, Solve Climate by 2030 - Nationwide Power Dialogs, Apr 2021

Panelist, China Town Hall 2020 - Brandeis University, Nov 2020

Co-Organizer, State Lead for the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, Solve Climate by 2030 - Nationwide Power Dialogs, Apr 2020

"Working group talks sustainability with Brandeis students and faculty". *The Justice*, Mar 2020

Panelist, Community Forum on Climate Change, Brandeis University, Feb 2020

"Views on the News": The Amazon Wildfire. *The Justice*, Sep 2019

Skills

R, Stata, Python, GitHub, LaTeX

Software Packages

fmlogit in R: Estimate (and post-estimate) fractional multinomial logit model.
Available at https://github.com/f1kidd/fmlogit

Personal Information

Married, 1 child

Language: English (Fluent), Chinese (Native)

Miscellaneous: Go (Strategy Game) 5 dan in Chinese Go Association & American Go Association

References

Available upon request.

Last updated: November 2, 2026